



Department of Veterans Affairs

APPOINTMENT OF VETERANS SERVICE ORGANIZATION AS CLAIMANT'S REPRESENTATIVE

VA DATE STAMP
(DO NOT WRITE
IN THIS SPACE)

INSTRUCTIONS: Before completing the form, read the Privacy Act and Respondent Burden on Page 3. The VA Office of General Counsel maintains a list of all attorneys, claims agents, and Veterans Service Organization (VSO) representatives accredited by VA to assist in preparing, presenting, and prosecuting claims for VA benefits at: <https://www.va.gov/ogc/apps/accreditation/index.asp>. You can search this list by name, state, or zip code. We recommend you use the list to confirm and validate VA accreditation before signing any contract or appointing someone to represent you on your VA benefits claim. If you prefer to have an individual assist you with your claim instead of a VSO, complete VA Form 21-22a, *Appointment of Individual as Claimant's Representative*. For more information, you can contact us through Ask VA: <https://ask.va.gov/>, or call us toll-free at 1-800-827-1000 (TTY:711). VA forms are available at www.va.gov/vaforms. After completing the form, use the mailing addresses provided on Page 4.

SECTION I: VETERAN'S INFORMATION

NOTE: You can *either* complete the form online or by hand. If completed by hand, print the information requested in ink, neatly, and legibly to expedite processing of the form.

1. VETERAN'S NAME (First, Middle Initial, Last)

J o h n M V e t e r a n

2. VETERAN'S SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER (SSN)
(999-99-9999)

1 2 3 - 4 5 - 6 7 8 9

3. VA FILE NUMBER (If applicable)

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

4. VETERAN'S DATE OF BIRTH (MM/DD/YYYY)

Month Day Year
1 2 - 3 1 - 1 9 8 0

5. VETERAN'S SERVICE NUMBER (If applicable)

A A 1 2 3 4 5

6. INSURANCE NUMBER(S) (If applicable) (Include letter prefix)

7. MAILING ADDRESS (Number and street or rural route, P.O. Box, City, State, ZIP Code and Country)

No. & Street 1 2 3 F a k e V e t e r a n S t

Apt./Unit Number City P o r t l a n d

State/Province O R Country U S ZIP Code/Postal Code 1 2 3 4 5 - 6 7 8 9

8. TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) ((999) 999-9999)
(555) 555-5555

9. EMAIL ADDRESS (Optional)
veteran@example.com

SECTION II: CLAIMANT'S INFORMATION (If other than veteran)

10. CLAIMANT'S NAME (First, Middle Initial, Last)

J o h n M C l a i m a n t

11A. CLAIMANT'S DATE OF BIRTH (MM/DD/YYYY)

Month Day Year
1 2 - 3 1 - 1 9 8 0

11B. RELATIONSHIP TO VETERAN

Spouse

12. MAILING ADDRESS (Number and street or rural route, P.O. Box, City, State, ZIP Code and Country)

No. & Street 1 2 3 F a k e C l a i m a n t S t

Apt./Unit Number City P o r t l a n d

State/Province O R Country U S ZIP Code/Postal Code 1 2 3 4 5 - 6 7 8 9

13. TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) ((999) 999-9999)
(555) 555-5555

14. EMAIL ADDRESS (Optional)
claimant@example.com

SECTION III: SERVICE ORGANIZATION INFORMATION

15. NAME OF SERVICE ORGANIZATION RECOGNIZED BY THE DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS (See list on Page 3 before selecting organization)

Best VSO

16A. NAME OF OFFICIAL REPRESENTATIVE ACTING ON BEHALF OF THE ORGANIZATION NAMED IN ITEM 15 (This is an appointment of the entire organization and does not indicate the designation of only this specific individual to act on behalf of the organization)

John M Representative

16B. JOB TITLE OF PERSON NAMED IN ITEM 16A

17. EMAIL ADDRESS OF THE ORGANIZATION NAMED IN ITEM 15

18. DATE OF THIS APPOINTMENT (MM/DD/YYYY)

SECTION IV: AUTHORIZATION INFORMATION				
19. AUTHORIZATION FOR REPRESENTATIVE'S ACCESS TO RECORDS PROTECTED BY SECTION 7332, TITLE 38, U.S.C. - By checking the box below I authorize VA to disclose to the service organization named on this appointment form any records that may be in my file relating to treatment for drug abuse, alcoholism or alcohol abuse, infection with the human immunodeficiency virus (HIV), or sickle cell anemia. ☒ I authorize the VA facility having custody of my VA claimant records to disclose to the service organization named in Item 15 all treatment records relating to drug abuse, alcoholism or alcohol abuse, infection with the human immunodeficiency virus (HIV), or sickle cell anemia. Redisclosure of these records by my service organization representative, other than to VA or the Court of Appeals for Veterans Claims, is not authorized without my further written consent. This authorization will remain in effect until the earlier of the following events: (1) I revoke this authorization by filing a written revocation with VA; or (2) I revoke the appointment of the service organization named in Item 15, either by explicit revocation or the appointment of another representative.				
20. LIMITATION OF CONSENT- I authorize disclosure of records related to treatment for all conditions listed in Item 19 except: ☐ DRUG ABUSE ☒ ALCOHOLISM OR ALCOHOL ABUSE ☐ INFECTION WITH THE HUMAN IMMUNODEFICIENCY VIRUS (HIV) ☐ SICKLE CELL ANEMIA				
21. AUTHORIZATION TO CHANGE CLAIMANT'S ADDRESS - By checking the box below, I authorize the organization named in Item 15 to act on my behalf to change my address in my VA records. ☒ I authorize any official representative of the organization named in Item 15 to act on my behalf to change my address in my VA records. This authorization does not extend to any other organization without my further written consent. This authorization will remain in effect until the earlier of the following events: (1) I file a written revocation with VA; or (2) I appoint another representative, or (3) I have been determined unable to manage my financial affairs and the individual or organization named in Item 16A is not my appointed fiduciary.				
I, the claimant named in Items 1 <i>or</i> 10, hereby appoint the service organization named in Item 15 as my representative to prepare, present and prosecute my claim(s) for any and all benefits from the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) based on the service of the veteran named in Item 1. I authorize VA to release any and all of my records, to include disclosure of my Federal tax information (other than as provided in Items 19 and 20), to my appointed service organization. I understand that my appointed representative will not charge any fee or compensation for service rendered pursuant to this appointment. I understand that the service organization I have appointed as my representative may revoke this appointment at any time, subject to 38 CFR 20.6. <i>Additionally, in some cases a veteran's income is developed because a match with the Internal Revenue Service necessitated income verification. In such cases, the assignment of the service organization as the veteran's representative is valid for only five years from the date the claimant signs this form for purposes restricted to the verification match.</i> Signed and accepted subject to the foregoing conditions.				
SECTION V: SIGNATURES				
NOTE: THIS POWER OF ATTORNEY DOES NOT REQUIRE EXECUTION BEFORE A NOTARY PUBLIC				
22A. SIGNATURE OF VETERAN OR CLAIMANT <i>(Do Not Print)</i> 			22B. DATE SIGNED <i>(MM/DD/YYYY)</i> 	
23A. SIGNATURE OF VETERANS SERVICE ORGANIZATION REPRESENTATIVE NAMED IN ITEM 16A <i>(Do Not Print)</i> 			23B. DATE SIGNED <i>(MM/DD/YYYY)</i> 	
NOTE: As long as this appointment is in effect, the organization named herein will be recognized as the sole representative for preparation, presentation and prosecution of your claim before the Department of Veterans Affairs in connection with your claim or any portion thereof.				
VA USE ONLY	COPY OF VA FORM 21-22 SENT TO: ☐ VR&E FILE ☐ LG FILE ☐ EDU FILE ☐ INSURANCE FILE	DATE SENT <i>(MM/DD/YYYY)</i>	ACKNOWLEDGED <i>(Date) (MM/DD/YYYY)</i>	REVOKED <i>(Reason)</i> DATE <i>(MM/DD/YYYY)</i>
PENALTY: The law provides severe penalties which include fine or imprisonment, or both, for the willful submission of any statement of a material fact, knowing it to be false or for the fraudulent acceptance of any payment to which you are not entitled.				

RECOGNIZED SERVICE ORGANIZATIONS

Membership in an organization is not a prerequisite to appointment of the organization as claimant's representative.

The following is a listing of national, regional, or local organizations recognized by the Secretary of Veterans Affairs in the preparation, presentation, and prosecution of claims under laws administered by the Department of Veterans Affairs.

African American PTSD Association	National Association for Black Veterans, Inc.
American Legion	National Association of County Veterans Service Officers, Inc.
American Red Cross	National Law School Veterans Clinic Consortium
American Veterans (AMVETS)	National Montford Point Marine Association, Inc.
Armed Forces Services Corporation	National Veterans Legal Services Program
Army and Navy Union, USA	National Veterans Organization of America
Blinded Veterans Association	Navajo Nation Veterans Administration
Catholic War Veterans of the U.S.A.	Navy Mutual Aid Association
Dale K. Graham Veterans Foundation	Paralyzed Veterans of America, Inc.
Disabled American Veterans	Polish Legion of American Veterans, U.S.A.
Fleet Reserve Association	Swords to Plowshares, Veterans Rights Organization, Inc.
Gold Star Wives of America, Inc.	The Retired Enlisted Association
Green Beret Foundation	United Spanish War Veterans of the United States
Italian American War Veterans of the United States, Inc.	United Spinal Association, Inc.
Jewish War Veterans of the United States	Veterans of Foreign Wars
Legion of Valor of the United States of America, Inc.	Veterans of the Vietnam War, Inc. & The Veterans Coalition
Marine Corps League	Veterans of World War I of the U.S.A., Inc.
Military Officers Association of America (MOAA)	Veterans' Voice of America
	Vietnam Veterans of America
	Wounded Warrior Project

Although agency titles vary, the following States and possessions maintain veterans service agencies which are recognized to present claims:

Alabama	Hawaii	Minnesota	North Dakota	Tennessee
American Samoa	Idaho	Mississippi	Northern Mariana Islands	Texas
Arizona	Illinois	Missouri	Ohio	Utah
Arkansas	Iowa	Montana	Oklahoma	Vermont
California	Kansas	Nebraska	Oregon	Virginia
Colorado	Kentucky	Nevada	Pennsylvania	Virgin Islands
Connecticut	Louisiana	New Hampshire	Puerto Rico	Washington
Delaware	Maine	New Jersey	Rhode Island	West Virginia
Florida	Maryland	New Mexico	South Carolina	Wisconsin
Georgia	Massachusetts	New York	South Dakota	Wyoming
Guam	Michigan	North Carolina		

PRIVACY ACT NOTICE: VA will not disclose information collected on this form to any source other than what has been authorized under the Privacy Act of 1974 or Title 38, Code of Federal Regulations 1.576 for routine uses (i.e., civil or criminal law enforcement, congressional communications, epidemiological or research studies, the collection of money owed to the United States, litigation in which the United States is a party or has an interest, the administration of VA programs and delivery of VA benefits, verification of identity and status, and personnel administration) as identified in the VA system of records, 58VA21/22/28, Compensation, Pension, Education, and Vocational Rehabilitation and Employment Records - VA, published in the Federal Register. Your obligation to respond is voluntary. However, the requested information is considered relevant and necessary to recognize a service organization as your representative and/or identify disclosable records. VA uses your SSN to identify your claim file. Providing your SSN will help ensure that your records are properly associated with your claim file. Giving us your SSN account information is voluntary. Refusal to provide your SSN by itself will not result in the denial of benefits. VA will not deny an individual benefits for refusing to provide his or her SSN unless the disclosure of the SSN is required by Federal Statute of law in effect prior to January 1, 1975, and still in effect. The responses you submit are considered confidential (38 U.S.C. 5701). Information submitted is subject to verification through computer matching programs with other agencies.

RESPONDENT BURDEN: We need this information to recognize the service organization you name to act on your behalf in the preparation, presentation, and prosecution of claims for VA benefits (38 U.S.C. 5902). We will also use the information to identify any VA records that we may disclose to the service organization (38 U.S.C. 5701(b)). Title 38, United States Code, allows us to ask for this information. We estimate that you will need an average of 5 minutes to review the instructions, find the information, and complete this form. VA cannot conduct or sponsor a collection of information unless a valid OMB control number is displayed. You are not required to respond to a collection of information if this number is not displayed. Valid OMB control numbers can be located on the OMB Internet Page at www.reginfo.gov/public/do/PRAMain. If desired, you can call 1-800-827-1000 to get information on where to send comments or suggestions about this form.

WHERE TO SEND YOUR WRITTEN CORRESPONDENCE

Documents may be submitted by mail, in person at a VA regional office or electronically. However, VA recommends submitting correspondence electronically as this is the fastest method of receipt.

VA provides several tools to assist in electronic submission. To learn more about how to submit documents and claims electronically, visit www.va.gov/disability/upload-supporting-evidence. You can also go directly to access.va.gov to digitally upload any correspondence using Direct Upload.

By visiting www.va.gov you can also check your claims status and learn about other VA benefits.

If you need assistance, you can find a local, accredited representative at <https://www.benefits.va.gov/vso/>.

If you prefer to mail your correspondence, please use the related mailing address below.

COMPENSATION CLAIMS	PENSION & SURVIVORS BENEFIT CLAIMS
Department of Veterans Affairs Evidence Intake Center PO Box 4444 Janesville, WI 53547-4444	Department of Veterans Affairs Pension Intake Center PO Box 5365 Janesville, WI 53547-5365
FIDUCIARY	BOARD OF VETERANS' APPEALS
Department of Veterans Affairs Fiduciary Intake PO Box 95211 Lakeland, FL 33804-5211	Department of Veterans Affairs Board of Veterans' Appeals PO Box 27063 Washington, DC 20038

These addresses serve **all United States** and **foreign locations**.